problem that exists there as a result of corruption and our inability to effectively deal with it, being not part of that country, not matter what aid package we propose, no matter what.

When corruption is so endemic just saying things like, you know, we have to deal with it, does not seem to be very clear to me, it does not seem to be clear to me how we can. I mean assume on one hand the Taliban are still hated by a majority of the people in this country or not that country, and there is no acceptance of the idea of having them back in power, there has got to be some alternative to that. And is it one that we can establish and is it one that we can in any way guarantee will be free of this corruption, of the corruption that has been problematic to date? I just do not know how to get there from here, that is all.

Ambassador Pickring. Mr. Tancredo, a terrifically important and very good question. There is no magic snake oil. We have in this country at least fought corruption. I wish I could say we were totally free of it, but you and I read the newspapers and we know.

Mr. Tancredo. Yes.

Ambassador Pickring. But at least we have a judiciary, we have a prosecutorial system, we have evidence, we have in fact a bias against corruption. Those are the ways that we know how to deal with it. We have to help others accept the fact that corruption is the rot that eats away at the vitality of a country and over time it will destroy governments and regimes and it will force change one way or the other. We have to convince them that in fact their future rests in a different course.

This is not easy. We have leverage and incentives. It is a long-term possibility. And you and I know because in fact we understand that in fact it has to be a constant preoccupation. It is not a Hollywood movie that ends at the end of the third reel when the glorious couple walks off into the sunset, corruption is finished, never to come back again.

So all of those things are true. But my own feeling is that countries have made that change. It takes a lot of time and a lot of effort. There are ways that people have to help them. But it does not begin with us; it has to kind of begin with our selling them on the notion that in the end they do not have anything unless they can work this problem.

Mr. Tancredo. Well, I think an important and an enormously difficult challenge for us, as difficult if not more so than the military one that confronts us.

And, General, why do the better armed and trained regular forces frequently relinquish their security role in the frontier regions to the poorly equipped—now Pakistan we are talking about, I am sorry—to poorly equipped Pashtun Frontier Corps?

General Jones. I think it is because of the sophistication of the problem in the region where regular Pakistani army units do not typically do well and have suffered a lot of casualties. And the tribal authorities representing the local population are sometimes, even though they are not as well equipped, are sometimes more capable of achieving the goals. This is a very sophisticated problem and I think one that the Government of Pakistan is going to have to deal with very centrally in order to resolve it.

Mr. Tancredo. Thank you.

General Jones. I would like to piggyback if I could on your question——

Mr. Tancredo. Sure.

General Jones [continuing]. To the Ambassador just for one sentence. And that is to say that the corruption problem in Afghanistan will not be addressed until the international community en masse levies a certain metric on the government itself to show demonstrated performance. And it is inexcusable in my view that this is not being done. We will never

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